

Paneer Butter Masala

Serves 4 · Preparation 20 minutes · Cooking 30 minutes

Ingredients

- 400 g paneer, cut into 2 cm cubes
- 4 medium tomatoes, roughly chopped
- 2 onions, sliced
- 12 cashew nuts, soaked in warm water for 15 minutes
- 3 tablespoons butter, plus 1 tablespoon for finishing
- 1 teaspoon ginger garlic paste
- 1 teaspoon Kashmiri red chilli powder
- 1/2 teaspoon garam masala
- 1 teaspoon dried fenugreek leaves, crushed
- 3 tablespoons fresh cream
- Salt to taste, 1 teaspoon sugar

Method

1. Melt two tablespoons of butter in a heavy pan. Add the onions and cook on medium heat until soft and pale gold, about eight minutes.
2. Add the ginger garlic paste and cook for a minute until the raw smell goes.
3. Add the tomatoes, cashews and salt. Cover and cook until the tomatoes collapse completely, about twelve minutes.
4. Cool slightly, then blend to a completely smooth puree. Pass through a sieve for a silkier gravy.
5. Return the puree to the pan with the remaining butter. Add chilli powder, sugar and a splash of water. Simmer for eight minutes, stirring often, until the gravy darkens and thickens.
6. Add the paneer cubes and simmer for four minutes. Do

not boil hard, or the paneer will turn rubbery.

7. Stir in the garam masala, crushed fenugreek leaves and cream. Turn off the heat.
8. Rest for five minutes before serving with naan or jeera rice.

Notes

Soak the paneer in warm salted water for ten minutes before use if it has been refrigerated; it softens considerably. The sugar is not optional, as it balances the acidity of the tomatoes.